EDUCATIONPLUS

H. Kalpana Rao

Language or literature?

A language centre in HEIs will help learners understand how language enables clear, precise communication and how literature cultivates insight and empathy through in-depth interpretations.

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Often, when I am introduced as a professor of English, the immediate response is "Oh, I need to be careful when I speak to you in English." Such comments point to a widespread confusion between language proficiency and the study of literature. This is a misconception that needs clarification.

Literature is more content-driven and deals with ideas and experiences and communicates to the reader through an emotional quotient. On the other hand, language is more about the structural aspects, such as understanding grammar, vocabulary, and syntax, and about knowing the underlying structure.

Language training

Although students and scholars of literature need to use language, most often their skills are deficient. Without recognising this difference, a common conjecture is that members of the English department– whether students, scholars, or teachers – possess strong English language skills. This has also led to many debates and discussions regarding the poor knowledge of English of students and scholars in the English department across Indian universities.

An important need in higher education today is training in language. This is not to say that literature students are unable to use language. They do but in a different way. They can analyse and deconstruct plots, stories, and narratives, explore cultural nuances, recognise discrimination, ponder social and political backdrops, and identify the plural meanings that a text offers.

Yet, they are unable to draft an essay with the nuanced perspective by which they read a text. In my personal experience, time and again, I have noted that submitted assignments lack coherence, grammatical accuracy, syntactical clarity, and clarity of meaning.

We need to, therefore, find a methodology to improve this. One solution is to set up a language centre that can provide training in English language skills and help scholars and students in academic writing. It is not just literature students who lack the skills necessary to author academic articles. Students and scholars in the sciences and other fields also find it difficult to communicate their research ideas clearly.

This lack of language proficiency also has implications for employability, as students and scholars struggle to write clear resumes, articulate confidently in interviews, and communicate well in professional settings.

In the case of researchers, inadequate language skills limit their ability to produce well-structured dissertations or critically engaged conference papers. Over time, these issues also erode confidence and make students hesitate to participate boldly and positively in academic forums.

Improved presentation

Another lacuna lies in presentation skills. Too often, scholars, including faculty members, prepare dull slides and speak without preparation, leading to frequent miscommunication and a sense of boredom among listeners. Therefore, a language centre may help by providing support to prepare strong, attractive slides and offering training in seminar presentations and speaking coherently. Additionally, it could also offer structured modules in grammar, vocabulary building, academic writing, and critical reading, along with workshops on citation practices, editing skills and communication.

Such a centre might also collaborate with different departments by designing specific writing sessions such as scientific writing for science students, report writing for social sciences, and research papers for humanities. The centre could be staffed by English language tutors who combine strong language skills with patience and a supportive approach to learners. Many universities abroad run such writing centres and communication labs that function as academic support hubs offering consultations and skill sustenance across the university.

It is significant that higher education institutions recognise that language is not merely a medium of instruction but a tool for thinking, shaping how students organise ideas, construct arguments and engage intellectually at a global level. This does not mean that literature is not necessary. On the other hand, literature nurtures critical consciousness by providing readers to analyse varied perspectives, recognise power structures, and explore the complexities of human experience. Higher education needs both these dimensions to exist side by side so that learners understand how language enables clear, precise communication and how literature cultivates insight and empathy through in-depth interpretations.

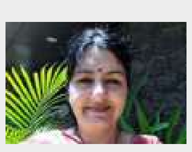
The writer is a former professor of English at Pondicherry University and now volunteers as the editor for the literary section of the online journal, Muse India. Email: hkalp.eng@pondiuni.ac.in

Ethics of AI

UNESCO has partnered with Coursera to launch a free course — Global MOOC on the Ethics of AI — developed in collaboration with LG AI Research. As AI adoption accelerates, this course helps learners and institutions put those principles into action and strengthen ethical decision-making on a global scale.

The new course teaches learners to recognise ethical risks, weigh competing priorities, and make more informed decisions about how AI is designed, used, and governed. It focuses on real-world applications, guided by insights from global experts at Carnegie Mellon University, the U.S.; the University of Toronto, Canada; the Alan Turing Institute, the U.K.; and more.

Available in 11 languages, including Arabic, Mandarin, English, French, Russian, Spanish, Korean, Hindi, Bahasa Indonesian, Italian, and Portuguese, the nine-hour course requires no advanced technical knowledge and is designed for learners across sectors, including university students, researchers, policymakers, and technology leaders. For more details, visit https://tinyurl.com/3mt8h3mc



OFF THE EDGE

Nandini Raman

Build your expertise

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help

I have completed B.A. B.Ed. and am doing M.A. English. I am interested in teaching. What should I do to upgrade myself? Also, are there better career options? Jothika

Dear Jothika,

You already have the qualifications to teach in schools across India. A Master's will open opportunities at higher-secondary and college levels. Consider AI and digital pedagogy certifications, Google Certified Educator (Level 1 and 2), Generative AI for Educators, and learning to use tools like Moodle, Canva, and interactive quiz platforms. For international schools, pursue IB Professional Development or Cambridge training. A TEFL/TESOL certification can help you teach English online, work abroad, or become a language specialist. Clear the CTET to teach in Kendriya Vidyalayas or Navodaya schools and the UGC NET for colleges. Alternative careers include instructional design (ed-tech), corporate communications or public relations, and technical writing.

I finished B.E. Civil Engineering and am working as an assistant engineer (KPSC). I am not interested in this job and am considering doing a Master's in Urban Design. Is it possible to pursue higher education while in government service? Will I be able to transition to departments related to urban planning or municipal administration? Bharat

Dear Bharat,

Urban planning or design will allow you to think strategically about cities, heritage and public spaces, blending your Civil Engineering background with creative problem-solving. Higher education while in government service is possible but you have to follow certain procedures. Under Appendix 9 of the KCSR, you are eligible for study leave (on half-pay) for up to two years after completing five years of regular service and clearing probation. If you wish to study earlier, obtain an official NOC from your department. After you get admission, you can apply for Extraordinary Leave (LWA), which pauses your salary but preserves your job and service continuity. The course must also have a direct connection with your duties.

Transitioning to Urban Planning or Municipal Departments is possible through deputation but a Master's degree will not change your role. Your designation will remain the same but your posting and functional portfolio can shift towards urban planning, municipal administration or Smart City projects through strategic deputations.

If you enjoy the security of government service but dislike your current work, do not resign. Secure your department's NOC, study at institutions like CEPT University or SPA Delhi, and use your specialised qualifications to steer your career towards Urban Planning and Municipal Administration. If you leave government service, opportunities exist as an urban designer, infrastructure planner, urban policy analyst, and so on.

I completed B.Tech in 2021 prepared for the UPSC IES. Since I didn't make it despite hard work, staying away from social media and friends, I am considering an M.Tech or M.S. in an IIT (I have the rank to join one) in aerospace design. But I feel frustrated because of my UPSC failure. How can I overcome this feeling? Yashas

Dear Yashas,

Be kind to yourself. You dedicated four years of your life to the UPSC. It is indeed "lost time" and it will hurt. Meet a competent counselling psychologist and work towards making peace with it and focus on moving forward. You may feel awkward reaching out to old friends, but true friends do not care about a gap on a résumé or an exam result.

An IIT campus is intellectually vibrant and you will meet peers who have also faced setbacks before finding their true calling. You will find your tribe. Aerospace design is a high-growth field, so, forget the idea of a "delayed start" and focus on your goals. Build strong technical expertise, target top research labs, convert your IES knowledge into research outputs, take up leadership roles, and aim for R&D opportunities at organisations such as ISRO, DRDO, Airbus, Boeing, GE Aerospace, HAL and emerging space-tech startups.

I finished Engineering in 2025 and am working in an IT company. I want to switch to finance. Should I do a CFA or an MBA? How can I build a strong profile? Sai

Dear Sai,

Both CFA and MBA can help you transition into finance but differ in cost, structure and career outcomes. CFA is a self-paced programme that you can pursue alongside your IT job. It is relatively affordable and focuses on investment management, equity research, portfolio management, derivatives and fixed income. It typically leads to roles in Asset Management, Equity Research, Portfolio Risk and Quantitative Finance.

A full-time MBA is a two-year residential programme. It is expensive and highly competitive at top institutions such as IIMs, ISB, XLRI and FMS. It focuses on corporate strategy, management, accounting, leadership and networking, opening doors to Investment Banking, Private Equity, Corporate Finance and Management Consulting.

Choose CFA if you enjoy mathematical analysis, market analytics and investment research. Pursue an MBA only if you secure admission to a top institute. If you choose CFA, combine your engineering skills with finance. Learn Python/R, build finance projects using pandas, numpy and matplotlib, create a GitHub portfolio, and master financial modelling and valuation, including DCF models.

When you move out of IT, target FinTech and Quant roles such as Quantitative Risk Analyst, Financial Data Engineer or Business/Financial Analyst, which provide a strong pathway into core finance.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge

Algorithm vs. aptitude

Why educational institutions must teach students to separate reels and trends from true calling

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Kokil Jain

Ask a first-year student today how they chose a career path and chances are the answer will mention a YouTube video, an Instagram reel, or a LinkedIn post that felt deeply personal. India's digital ecosystem has fundamentally reshaped how youngsters imagine success, identity, and work. In the age of AI, career aspirations are increasingly being shaped through feeds, creators, recommendation engines, and viral narratives.

Parallel ecosystem

With India crossing 958 million Internet users in 2025, youngsters between 15 and 24 years now spend anywhere between three and seven hours daily on digital platforms, according to the *Internet in India Report 2025*. Social media has become a parallel career ecosystem with platforms continuously exposing students to ideas of what success should look like, which industries are "future-proof", and which career paths are considered aspirational.

This means that aspiration has become more democratised in fundamental ways. A student from tier-2 and tier-3 cities can learn about roles in products, AI engineering, start-up entrepreneurs, analysts and creators through reels and podcasts. Instagram and LinkedIn are gradually shaping decisions around higher education and careers, a move that gained speed with the arrival of AI. However, social media is not a level playing field. Algorithms promote reels, fame, and daring. Careers in research, commercial academia, public policy, education, or social innovation are not highlighted as much as the start-up culture, well-paid software engineer opportunities, or celebrity platforms.

Social media distils complicated career pathways into bite-sized, emotionally charged stories. A progress sweep becomes a motivational reel. A startup funding round becomes a trophy of achievement. What is left unsaid is the nuance, the compromises, the hard-won patience, and the conditions leading up to those results. Students see outcomes but not the journey leading to them. Then comes the fear generated by AI. Students worry not only about the ability of a task to decide their career but about the probability of being automated. However, the algorithms can also direct students to "hot" options that may not be right for them. An example of this is the viral debate about the "uselessness" of an MBA or the role of Management education in an AI-driven economy.

Identity shift

Perhaps the deeper transformation lies in identity formation itself. Earlier generations explored professional identities gradually through internships, mentorship, and lived experiences. Today's students begin constructing professional personas online long before entering the workforce. LinkedIn profiles become curated identities, and career ambitions are publicly declared early. Validation increasingly comes through likes, shares, and visibility.

In turn, this leads to the need for a more forceful response from educational institutions. What is required is career literacy programmes. Beyond employability, students must be guided to understand the difference between knowledge building and following the herd. As algorithms shape aspiration more than ever, institutions that foster relationships and intellectual rigour will help students build careers that are both resilient and purposeful.

The writer is Dean of Research and Outreach at Fortune Institute of International Business (FIIB), New Delhi.

SCHOLARSHIPS

GEV Memorial Merit Scholarship for Law Students

An initiative of the GEV Scholarship Fund Trust.

Eligibility: Indian citizens pursuing LL.B. or LL.M. in India or appearing for CLAT, LSAT-India, AILET, or other Law entrance exams and have minimum 60% in Classes 10 and 12 and an annual family income not exceeding ₹10,00,000 from all sources.

Rewards: ₹50,000 to ₹200,000 a year and mentorship

Application: Online

Deadline: August 15

www.b4s.in/edge/GMM5

U-GO Scholarship

An initiative by U-GO.

Eligibility: Young Indian women in any year (except those in the final year) of a graduation programme in Teaching, Nursing, Pharmacy, Medicine, Engineering, Architecture, Law, and related fields with at least 70% in Classes 10 and 12 and with an annual family income not exceeding ₹500,000 from all sources.

Rewards: Up to ₹60,000 a year.

Application: Online

Deadline: August 20

www.b4s.in/edge/UGO6

Panasonic Ratti Chhatr Scholarship

An initiative by Panasonic Life Solutions India.

Eligibility: Indian students with minimum 75% in Class 12 who have secured admission to B.E. or B.Tech. programmes at any IIT in the academic year 2026-27 and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹800,000 from all sources.

Rewards: ₹70,250 a year.

Application: Online

Deadline: August 20

www.b4s.in/edge/RCSP7

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Engineering for the future

Three crucial skills that Civil Engineering students must develop

Sanjay Kumar Sinha

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As India continues scaling its infrastructure development, Civil Engineering projects are becoming increasingly complex. Therefore, students have to go beyond technical expertise and develop an understanding of policy, emerging technologies, and project management.

Policy matters

While Engineering is driving India's infrastructure development, the policy environment influences how these projects move. In most cases, environmental clearance, land acquisition disputes, and financial considerations influence a project as much as technical problems. According to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, as of March 2026, there were 1,941 central sector projects with a revised cost of more than ₹41.5 lakh crores, with an overrun cost of ₹5.61 lakh crores.

For students, this highlights an important reality and emphasises that the delivery of infrastructure requires not only technical skills but also an understanding of the policy and regulatory landscape and issues related to environmental impact assessment, land law, and public-private partnerships (PPPs). Equally important is an awareness of where to access policy developments. Platforms such as NITI Aayog, the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, and the Press Information Bureau provide regular updates, helping students connect academic learning to real-world infrastructure priorities.

Technological advances

Due to the growing use of advanced technologies, the way civil engineering projects are planned and executed is evolving quickly. Tools like Building Information Modelling (BIM) and AI-driven analytics are helping improve accuracy and streamline workflows, while drones are now able to survey sites within a few centimetres of precision, cutting timelines by nearly 50-70%. Moreover, technology has also brought changes in terms of surveillance and maintenance. The use of IoT devices has made it easier to monitor assets like bridges and tunnels, while blockchain has helped achieve greater transparency in the logistics sector.

For students, knowledge of all this becomes crucial because the increasing growth rate of the sector implies the need to stay updated with the technology being used.

Project management

The global construction sector is facing an impending generation gap that may see approximately 41% of its professionals retiring by 2031. These individuals have critical skills to handle multi-disciplinary projects involving different stakeholders. World Bank studies in India reveal that some of the perennial problems faced in infrastructure projects include delayed completion, high costs, and contract disputes.

Therefore, another critical skill for students is project management. Familiarity with critical path methodology, earned value analysis, contract administration using FIDIC and MoRTH conditions, and resource planning will help forecast the risks involved and enable them to deliver projects successfully.

Civil engineering students who build genuine competence across all three domains, supported by industry-academia partnerships, structured internships, and live project exposure, will be the professionals that India's expressways, metro networks, smart cities, and water systems genuinely require.

The writer is the founder and Managing Director of Chaitanya Projects Consultancy.

The focus fix

Why attention should be listed as a competency in higher education

THE KNOWLEDGE GAP

Ram Kumar Kakani

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

There is a Jataka tale about monkeys that were asked to water a king's garden. Wanting to be efficient, they decide each sapling needs exactly as much water as the length of its root. So, they pull up every plant to measure it. The garden dies of good intentions.

I thought of those monkeys while a bright postgraduate student explained her study routine: four productivity apps, a Pomodoro timer, two accountability groups, and a phone that buzzed nine times during our 30-minute conversation. She was uprooting her attention to check whether it was growing.

The numbers are no longer anecdotal. EY found Indians spent 1.1 trillion hours on smartphones in 2024, about five hours a day per user. A January 2026 study in the International Journal of Indian Psychology found rising screen time tracking falling attention.

We have built an education system that assumes sustained attention while operating in an environment that dismantles it.

The knowledge gap is not between what students know and what they should know but between what we ask of their attention and what we have built to support it. NEP 2020 asks for critical thinking; not one syllabus lists attention as a competency. We examine what we never taught.

Our instinct, being a nation fond of exhortation, is to prescribe willpower. Concentrate harder. Wake at 4.00 am. Take a vow.

A senior school principal in Bengaluru put it plainly: "We kept adding a new app for attendance, another for assignments, a parents' group. Nobody ever asked what we should stop."

Her instinct – that the problem is accumulation, not indiscipline – echoes cognitive psychologist Yousri Marzouki's article in Psyche. He calls this 'psychological minimalism': the trouble is not a deficit of technique but an excess of cognitive noise. Willpower is a private virtue; structure is a public good.

Audit before the vow

For students, the first step is reconnaissance, not renunciation. Marzouki asks for one day marking every attention leak: each phone glance, each tab-hop and then name the three highest-frequency, lowest-value inputs.

This is where Student Development Programmes should begin: an audit process uses personal data, which persuades where exhortation cannot.

A student who discovers she checked her lock screen 60 times before lunch has learned something no seminar could teach her.

Any counselling unit could run this in three weeks: count, subtract, then a 'Daily Card' naming one protected block. Research on attention residue suggests 23 minutes to recover deep focus after a single interruption.

Attention as infrastructure

For faculty, how much classroom distraction do our own design choices manufacture? A slide with 42 words and three animations is not a teaching aid; it is a competing bid for attention.

Three fixes. Mono-task the segment: one idea per 15-20 minutes, one visual, one question. A phone tray at the door beats a lecture on discipline. Third, teach with constraint; ask for a 50-word abstract instead of a 500-word essay. Constraint reduces decision load while preserving meaning making.

For leadership, this implicates calendars. Cancelling one recurring low-value meeting and protecting a daily focus block is a governance decision, not a personal one. Meeting culture fragments the day of exactly those people whose deep work determines rankings and such outcomes.

Meeting hygiene as policy: no agenda, no meeting; a protected no-meetings window. A university that cannot say when its scholars think has not scheduled a calendar; it has scheduled an interruption.

Every institution audits what it spends; none audits what it asks people to remember.

Model it. If the Vice-Chancellor's office sends WhatsApp messages at 11.00 pm, no policy will save the institution. Culture is what leaders do on ordinary Tuesdays.

The monkeys watered the garden to death because they measured what was easy to measure.

We do the same with attention: counting hours logged, lectures delivered, credits accumulated while losing the capacity that makes any of it mean anything.

Here are three steps that can help. First, turn off 11 notifications. Pick the ones you never once acted on. Second, cancel one meeting, the recurring one nobody defends. Watch what fails to collapse. Third, protect one hour. Same time daily, door shut, phone in another room.

The garden, it turns out, mostly needs to be left alone to grow.

Views expressed are personal

The writer is the Vice-Chancellor of RV University, Karnataka.

Booked by bots

Reimagining Tourism Education in the AI age

Shefali Joshi

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The travel and hospitality sector is undergoing a structural transformation driven by AI, data analytics, and smart tourism ecosystems. As the industry shifts toward automation, predictive intelligence, and hyper-personalised experiences, travel education must evolve from traditional service models to technology-integrated and data-driven learning frameworks.

AI is already deeply embedded in global tourism operations. A significant proportion of travel companies now deploy generative AI for customer-facing services such as booking assistance, internal analytics and decision-making. Thus, education must move beyond operational training to include AI literacy, automation systems, and advanced data analytics as core competencies.

Curriculum reboot

Therefore, hospitality and travel programmes can no longer remain confined to domains such as front-office management or food-and-beverage operations. Instead, they must be interdisciplinary, integrating digital strategy, predictive modelling, and platform-based service design. The future graduate is expected not only to manage operations but to interpret real-time data, optimise systems, and design seamless, tech-enabled travel experiences.

A critical shift is curricula driven by real-time industry data and predictive insights. Static textbooks are increasingly insufficient in a sector where consumer behaviour, pricing models, and demand patterns change dynamically. Institutions must embed live dashboards, industry datasets, and AI-powered analytics tools into the learning process to enable students make decisions based on current market signals rather than retrospective case studies.

Equally important is the adoption of immersive learning environments using technologies such as Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR). The latter can help students manage virtual hotels, respond to real-time guest situations, or navigate crises in a controlled environment. Virtual replicas of real-world destinations allow learners to analyse tourist flows, sustainability challenges, and infrastructure planning without physical constraints. This helps bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and experiential learning at scale.

Smart destinations rely on interconnected systems powered by AI, the Internet of Things, and big data to deliver seamless and efficient experiences such as AI-driven chatbots and dynamic pricing, to biometric-enabled travel and real-time itinerary optimisation. Travel education must prepare students to work within and design for, these ecosystems.

At the heart of this transformation is the growing importance of hyper-personalisation, which requires professionals who can design journeys powered by recommendation engines, behavioural data, and predictive algorithms. Consequently, curricula must include modules on customer data platforms, experience design, and AI-driven personalisation strategies.

Human element

However, the integration of technology does not diminish the human element. It amplifies it. Institutions must adopt a human-centric approach in which empathy, cultural intelligence, and ethical judgement remain foundational. Faculty play a critical role in this transition, as facilitators who bridge advanced technological tools with real-world application and human insight. The classroom of the future should be hybrid, combining AI-enabled learning tools with mentorship-driven engagement.

Another essential dimension is the integration of ethics, data privacy, and responsible AI use into the curriculum. As technology adoption accelerates, concerns around algorithmic bias, data security, and digital inequity are increasing. Travel education must proactively address these challenges by embedding governance frameworks and ethical decision-making into programme structures, ensuring that graduates are not only skilled but also responsible practitioners.

As routine functions become automated, the demand for skills such as critical thinking, adaptability, digital fluency, and cross-disciplinary collaboration is rising. This necessitates a shift from static degree programmes to continuous, lifelong learning ecosystems, supported by strong industry-academia partnerships and modular curricula that are constantly being updated.

With the future of travel education at the intersection of AI, immersive technologies, data intelligence, and human experience, preparing graduates for this new reality is not just about keeping pace with the industry, but also about shaping its future.

The writer is Dean, School of Hospitality Management, NMIMS.

Don't ban, guide the use

Why India's education system needs to shape how learners use AI

Shantanu Rooj

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Higher education faces a new challenge. The issue is no longer that students use AI tools; they do, and they will continue to. The deeper question is whether teaching, assessment and academic trust are still suited to a world where final submissions no longer reliably reflect effort, originality or understanding. Used well, AI deepens learning; used carelessly, it creates the illusion of understanding. The debate must move beyond banning AI to building systems where it strengthens learning without weakening judgement, accountability or academic integrity..

Change the question

In an AI-enabled world, a polished essay, presentation, or line of code may reflect genuine understanding or just effective use of AI. This does not mean students are less capable. It means education needs better ways to assess capability. An AI writing detection platform found that 11% of over 200 million student papers contained AI-written language in at least 20% of the submission, while 3% had 80% or more AI-generated text. So, the question must shift from "Did the student produce this?" to "Can the student explain, defend, apply, and improve it?"

Using AI does not automatically make students AI-ready. A student may know how to generate responses, but not verify them; summarise information, but not test arguments; produce code, but not debug it. This distinction matters because AI is becoming a workplace expectation. Research shows 62% of higher education students believe responsible AI use is essential for career success, while 80% see AI as important for their future. AI-ready graduates should do more than use tools; they must ask better questions, verify outputs, identify bias, protect data, cite responsibly and know when human judgement should override AI.

Two strategies

AI governance in education is often seen as a policy issue: what is allowed, prohibited or considered misconduct. While these rules matter, institutions must also ask: What should students learn to do with AI? How should faculty redesign assignments? How can assessment distinguish between assistance and dependency? What should AI-ready graduate demonstrate?

This requires two parallel strategies: using AI to teach better and teaching students to use AI better. Faculty can use AI to create case studies, question banks, and personalised feedback, which gives more time for mentoring and discussion. Students, meanwhile, need prompt literacy, source verification, responsible citation, bias detection, and data privacy skills.

Most conversations about AI in education focus on student misuse. But the success of AI-enabled education will depend equally on faculty readiness. A global survey of 1,681 faculty members across 52 higher education institutions in 28 countries found strong engagement with AI, alongside a clear need for better institutional support, governance, and AI literacy.

Prepare the educator

Educators need three things: an understanding of AI's strengths and limits, tools to design assessments that go beyond AI-generated outputs, and confidence to evaluate reasoning, application, and judgement. UNESCO's AI competency frameworks reinforce this by emphasising human-centred thinking, ethics, AI foundations and pedagogy.

Instead of banning AI, institutions should promote guided use: clearly defining where AI is permitted, when disclosure is required, and how students should verify and improve AI-generated work. The goal is not AI-free campuses, but AI-ready campuses.

Education is built on trust. Employers trust that a degree reflects capability, institutions trust that assessments reflect learning, and students trust that education prepares them for the future. AI requires us to rethink how this trust is built. Therefore, assignments should show drafts, reasoning, and source choices. Projects should focus on unfamiliar problems, while viva-based evaluations should become more common. AI-assisted work should include disclosure and verification, and assessment should reward judgment, originality, collaboration, and responsible AI use.

India's education system does not need to fight AI; it needs to shape how learners use it. The shift must be from fear-led restriction to structured enablement, and from output-based assessment to process-based evaluation. The future belongs not to those with AI access but to those who use it wisely, think independently, and apply knowledge responsibly.

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